

BEFORE ADOPTION

New Pet Checklist

A simple checklist to help you prepare the essentials before your new companion arrives.

Home essentials

- ☐ Food appropriate for the pet and clean food and water bowls.
- ☐ A comfortable bed, crate, enclosure, or quiet resting area suited to the animal.
- ☐ Collar or harness, identification tag, and a secure leash for dogs where appropriate.
- ☐ Litter box and litter for cats, or a suitable enclosure and bedding setup for rabbits.
- ☐ Age-appropriate toys, enrichment items, and safe chews or scratching options.
- ☐ Pet-safe cleaning supplies and a plan for storing food, medication, and household chemicals securely.

Before pickup

- ☐ Confirm the adoption appointment, pickup details, and any documents you need to bring.
- ☐ Ask what food and routine the pet is currently used to so the transition can be gradual.
- ☐ Choose a veterinarian and save the clinic contact information.
- ☐ Pet-proof the areas your new companion will use during the first few days.
- ☐ Plan a calm arrival day with minimal visitors and enough time for the pet to settle.

Keep it simple

You do not need to buy everything at once. Start with safe essentials, learn what your pet actually prefers, and add items as their routine becomes clearer.